SOP-PSP-08

Choosing a Protected Space

Decision Flowchart — Home Front Command Guidelines

When a Red Alert sounds, choose the **highest-priority** option you can reach **within the time available**. Enter and **wait 10 minutes**.

1 Mamad / Mamak / Mamam

Residential, floor, or institutional protected room

- Close door tightly, turn handle 90°
- Close external steel window AND internal glass window
- If double-wing glass: remove wings in advance, store outside room

Preferred choice. If your building has one, always use it.

2 Shelter

Communal building shelter or public shelter

- Building shelter — reachable within time to shelter, or via windowless inner stairwell
- Public shelter — must be reachable within time to shelter

Best option if no Mamad/Mamak/Mamam in your building.

3 Inner Stairwell

Stairwell without windows or exterior walls

- Stay in the CENTER — not top floor, not bottom/entrance floor
- 3+ floor building: stay where at least 2 floors are above you
- 3-story building: middle floor staircase only
- Stay ON the staircase, not in the hallway; keep clear of obstacles

Poured concrete structural core — proven to save lives.

4 Inner Room

Innermost space, maximum walls, minimum windows

- Sit close to an inner wall, BELOW window line, NOT facing the door
- Close all doors and windows; an inner corridor also works
- No ceramics, porcelain, or glass that may shatter

5 Last Resort — Open Ground

No building or structure reachable in time

- Lie flat on the ground and protect your head with your hands

Also applies if in a caravan/prefab and cannot reach shelter in time.

NOT valid protected spaces: Kitchen · Bathroom · Toilet · Building entrance lobby · Caravans/prefab · Areas with ceramics, porcelain, or glass

DISCLAIMER: Not an official government resource. Use at your own risk. Based on HFC (Pikud HaOref) publications as of 12 Mar 2026. Official guidance: oref.org.il.